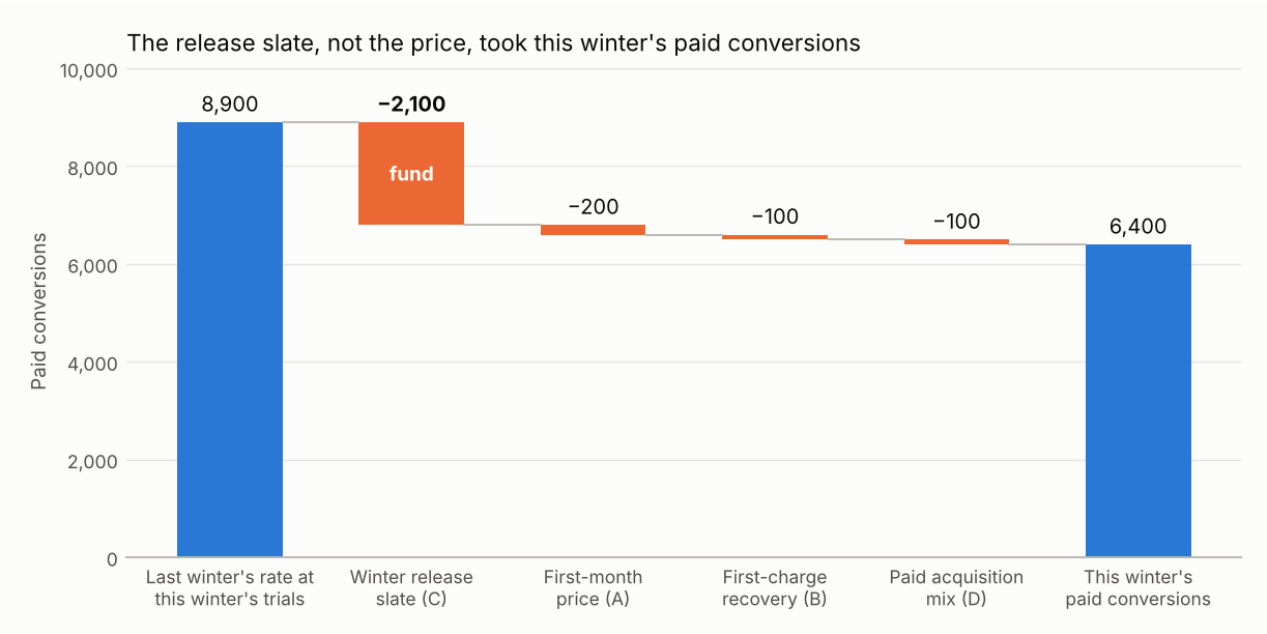
Fund the winter release slate for November 2026

To: subscriber growth budget review, March 2026. From: Subscriber Growth Analytics. 9 March 2026. Subject: the 2025-26 winter fall in trial-to-paid conversion and the programme to fund.

Fund the winter release slate (C). Paid conversion of the November to January trials fell from 51.7 to 37.1 per cent. At this winter's trials that is about 2,500 paid conversions; about 2,100 of them went with the winter's release slate, about 200 with the new first-month price, and about 100 each with first-charge recovery and the paid acquisition mix. The price hold is the runner-up, about 1,900 conversions behind.

Why the slate and not the price: a trialist pays at day 7 when a season they are watching still has episodes to come. Last winter 70.2 per cent of trialists were playing a season that was still releasing when their trial ended, and they paid at 56.9 per cent against 39.4 per cent for the rest. This winter nothing new aired after the autumn finales of 24 and 31 October, so no trialist had a season still to come. Among trialists with nothing to come, conversion fell only from 39.4 to 37.1 per cent between the winters, and that small fall, net of first-charge recovery and the channel mix, is what the price cost. The drop on 1 November looks like the price because the finales and the price change landed the same week, and sign-ups on finished seasons fell too because last winter those trialists went on to watch Marrow Creek while it aired.



Trials started 1 November to 31 January in each winter, by start date in Toronto time; paid conversions to the nearest hundred. Sources: trial register, both processors' first-charge attempts, trial viewing, release calendar.

The stages show the same thing: the share of trials that played an episode held (94.3 against 94.0 per cent), the share still subscribed at the end of the trial fell from 52.7 to 38.4, and first-charge collection slipped from 98.0 to 96.6 per cent with the shorter retry schedule.

The slate needs Gravel & Gold locked by July to air from November (programme sheet, line C). Stage shares are of each winter's trials, first charges collected of those attempted (conversion standard, section 3). Trials started 25 to 31 October 2025, whose first charge fell under the new price, sit in neither winter. Detail: trial_conversion_review.xlsx.